

KARANDAAZ PAKISTAN

Request for Proposal – 185

for

**Hiring of a Consulting Firm for Development of a Detailed Business Plan & Strategy for Raast
Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited (RPP)**

14th May, 2026

REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

Country:	Pakistan
Title of RFP:	Hiring of a Consulting Firm for Development of a Detailed Business Plan & Strategy for Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited (RPP)
RFP Number:	185
Issuance date of RFP:	14 th May, 2026
Last date for Queries:	21 st May, 2026
Response to Queries:	22 nd May, 2026
Closing date of RFP:	12 th June, 2026
Address RFP response to:	Procurement Department
E-mail Address:	procurement@karandaaz.com.pk

SECTION 1. LETTER OF INVITATION

RFP No. 185

14th May 2026, Islamabad

1. The purpose of this Request for Proposal (the “RFP”) is to solicit proposals from interested bidders for providing “Hiring of a Consulting Firm for Development of a Detailed Business Plan & Strategy for Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited (RPP)” The RFP is designed to assess whether bidders are able to provide the goods and services required (hereinafter jointly and severally referred to as the “Services”), and through a competitive and fair assessment, select a winning bidder for the Services for a long-term contract.
2. Karandaaz Pakistan invites sealed proposals from interested and eligible bidders. Further details on the Services required are provided in the Terms of Reference (Section 4 of RFP).
3. The bidder will be selected, in accordance with the Procurement Policies and Procedures of Karandaaz Pakistan (the “KRN Policy and Procedures”). In the event of any conflict or inconsistency in terms and conditions of the RFP and the KRN Policy and Procedures, the KRN Policy and Procedures shall prevail.
4. Karandaaz Pakistan anticipates issuing a Fixed Price Contract.
5. An award will be made based on the Quality and Cost based selection.
6. This RFP is only an invitation to the prospective Bidders to submit their proposal. It primarily contains indicative terms for the Bidders to submit their proposals and does not confer any rights to the Bidders. Any information contained in the RFP or provided to the Bidders is on the terms and conditions set out in this RFP. Karandaaz is providing this RFP without any warranty or representation, express or implied, as to its content, its accuracy or completeness and may at its absolute discretion, but without being under any obligation to do so, update, amend or supplement the information of this RFP. Each Bidder shall be responsible for conducting its own investigation and analysis and should check the accuracy, reliability and completeness of this RFP and where necessary obtain independent advice. In case of conflict between the provisions of this RFP and Addendum(s) to the RFP, the provisions of this RFP shall prevail unless stated otherwise. In case of any conflict between the provisions of this RFP, the decision of the Purchaser shall be final regarding the overriding effect of the respective provision.
7. Both technical and financial proposals must be submitted in a hard copy and electronically through email with subject: **“Hiring of a Consulting Firm for Development of a Detailed**

Business Plan & Strategy for Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited (RPP)” on or before 12th June, 2026. Bidders must prepare one hard copy of the technical proposal and one hard copy of the financial proposal, and submit them in separate sealed envelopes to the attention of ‘The Procurement Department’ 1-E, Ali Plaza, D Chowk, Mezzanine Floor, Nazimuddin Road, Blue Area, Islamabad, Pakistan. Bidders **MUST** also submit electronic copies of technical & financial proposals through email at procurement@karandaaz.com.pk. Bidders must also submit password protected electronic copies of financial proposal. Password for financial proposal will be requested by Karandaaz procurement department at the time of financial opening (if needed).

Soft copy of the bids/proposals shall be considered in case of any discrepancy found with hardcopy.

Yours sincerely,
The Procurement Department
Karandaaz Pakistan

SECTION 2. INSTRUCTIONS TO BIDDERS

A. General

1 Scope of Proposal

Karandaaz Pakistan issues this Request for Proposals (the “RFP”) for the following Services:
“Hiring of a Consulting Firm for Development of a Detailed Business Plan & Strategy for Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited (RPP)”

Throughout this RFP:

- i. The term “in writing” means communicated in written form (e.g., by mail, e-mail, fax)
- ii. “Day” means calendar day

2 Fraud and Corruption

Bidders shall comply with Karandaaz Pakistan’s policy regarding fraud and corruption set out in Section 3 of the RFP.

3 Eligibility

Karandaaz Pakistan may specify certain minimum qualification criteria in the Terms of Reference in Section 4 of the RFP e.g., minimum years of relevant experience; etc.

Bidders shall be under an obligation to disclose to Karandaaz Pakistan any situation of actual or potential conflict that impacts their capacity to perform/act in accordance with Karandaaz Pakistan’s best interests or pose a conflict of interest. Failure to disclose such situations may lead to the disqualification of a bidder or the termination of its contract. Karandaaz Pakistan’s policy with regard to conflict of interest is specified in Clause 33 of Section 3 of the RFP.

Bidders shall, upon request, provide evidence of their continued eligibility to the satisfaction of Karandaaz Pakistan, as may be requested from them from time to time.

Bidders shall be under an obligation to disclose to Karandaaz Pakistan whether they are a Related Party of Karandaaz Pakistan. Failure to disclose may lead to the disqualification of a bidder or the termination of its contract. Karandaaz Pakistan’s policy with regard to related parties is summarized in Clause 35 of Section 3 of the RFP.

4 One Proposal Per Bidder

An entity can participate only in one bid: as a single bidder, as a lead in a consortium/ joint venture or as a partner in a consortium / joint venture. Partnership firms or similar entities in different jurisdiction which work under common brand name or a part of affiliated network will be regarded as single entity and may not participate in more than one bid. Similarly associates and subsidiaries of an entity will be regarded as a part of a group and may not participate in multiple bids. Bidders may ask for clarification and any decision in this regard by Karandaaz Pakistan shall be deemed to be final.

Karandaaz Pakistan will not allow sub-contracting under any circumstances.

5 Cost of Preparation of Proposal

The bidder shall bear all costs associated with the preparation and submission of its proposal. Karandaaz Pakistan shall not be responsible or liable for any such costs, regardless of the conduct or outcome of the bidding process.

B. Request for Proposal

6 Contents of the RFP

The RFP comprises of the documents listed below plus any Addendum issued pursuant to Clause 8, of Section 2 'Amendment of RFP'.

- Section 1 - Letter of Invitation
- Section 2 - Instructions to bidders
- Section 3 – Procurement Policy – bidder conduct
- Section 4 – Terms of Reference
- Section 5 – Guiding Principles on Contract Terms and Conditions
- Annexure A – Proposal Submission Form
- Annexure B – Undertaking that the firm is not blacklisted
- Annexure C – Conflict of Interest Form
- Annexure D – Related Party Disclosure

7 Clarification of RFP

All questions and/or clarifications regarding this RFP must be submitted via email to Procurement@karandaaz.com.pk no later than 21st May 2026. All correspondence and/or inquiries regarding this solicitation must reference the RFP number. No phone calls or in-person inquiries will be entertained; all questions and inquiries must be in writing.

Questions and requests for clarification—and the responses thereto—will be uploaded on Karandaaz Pakistan's website on 22nd May 2026.

Only written answers will be considered official and carry weight in the RFP process and subsequent evaluation. Any verbal information received from a Karandaaz Pakistan employee or other entity should not be considered as an official response to any questions regarding this RFP.

8 Amendment of RFP

At any time prior to the deadline for submission of bids, Karandaaz Pakistan may amend the RFP by issuing an Addendum. Any Addendum so issued shall be part of the RFP and will be sent directly to the bidders via email. To give prospective bidders reasonable time in which to take an Addendum into account in preparing their bids, Karandaaz Pakistan may, at its discretion, extend the deadline for the submission of bids, pursuant to Clause 16 of Section 2 'Deadline for Submission of Proposals'.

C. Preparation and Submission of Proposals

9 Language of proposal

All documents relating to the proposal shall be written in the English language.

10 Documents Comprising the Proposal

A proposal shall consist of the following:

1. Technical Pre-qualification Documents

- I. Proposal submission form (Annexure A)

- II. The lead entity is registered/incorporated for the last 03 years (in Pakistan or elsewhere). Provide valid registration/incorporation documents, tax registration certificates and for entity incorporated in Pakistan, confirmation of appearance on FBR Active Taxpayer List
- III. Minimum average turnover of the bidder should be PKR 150 million over the last 2 years and minimum turnover of PKR 90 million for any individual year out of the past 2 years
- IV. Audited financial statements for past 02 years.
- V. The bidder must provide a minimum of three client references for comparable projects (related to entities involved in digital payment infrastructure/schemes/systems), including complete and verifiable contact details. Additionally, the bidder must demonstrate experience in at least three large-scale assignments completed involving the development of strategic roadmaps, including proven expertise in instant payment ecosystems—covering scheme design, participant models,—with demonstrated participation in at least one instant payment scheme implementation and strategy development initiative; as well as experience in pricing strategies and revenue frameworks for digital infrastructure, governance design in multi-stakeholder environments (including regulators, banks, fintechs, and government entities), and the delivery of execution-ready implementation roadmaps that go beyond high-level or conceptual strategy.
- VI. In case, the proposed team comprises overseas nationals, a certificate must be provided that those individuals will be able to travel to Pakistan and remain in Pakistan as and when required for the assignment. Nationals, permanent residents or people originating from India and/or Israel must not be included in the proposed team even if they hold dual nationality and a passport from any other country.
- VII. The bidder has not been blacklisted within Pakistan or any other jurisdiction. An undertaking must be provided to this effect (Annexure B).
- VIII. Declaration of availability to work on the assignment during the stipulated timeframe
- IX. Consortiums may apply (lead firm must be specified; letter of partnership to be included in annexes; prerequisites will apply to all consortium partners
- X. The bidder will be disqualified if:
 - a) Claimed Inclusive Instant Payment Scheme (IIPS) experience cannot be validated;
 - b) Experience is limited to generic consulting frameworks without implementation exposure;
 - c) Submitted proposals rely heavily on standardized/global templates without contextual relevance; and/or
 - d) Key personnel proposed are not available for the duration of the assignment

**Note: Applicants that fail to meet the pre-qualification criteria will be excluded from the Proposal Evaluation.*

2. Technical proposal consisting of the following;

- a. Profile of the firm/ company and profiles of key joint venture/consortium members (if applying as a joint venture/consortium)
- b. Proposed methodology and approach for strategy development, aligned with the requirements outlined in the Terms of Reference (TORs) including details on the approach taken to understand the local market, engagement with

relevant players, international benchmarking (e.g., with UPI, Pix, Faster Payments, JoPACC, Saudi Payments, SEPA etc.), understanding of the working of RPPL, regulatory environment etc.

- c. Proposed timeline of the deliverables mentioned in the detailed Terms of Reference of the project given in this RFP.
- d. Proven delivery of digital payments infrastructure/schemes with strong stakeholder collaboration; include at least 3 verifiable references covering strategic roadmaps, business plans, and financial models—preferably in financial services across local and international contexts. Details of project with contact details of the client/project completed. Client reference with verifiable contact details.
- e. Detailed proposed project team, including comprehensive profiles of key experts, clearly defining their roles, responsibilities, and allocation within the assignment, in line with the requirements given in the Terms of Reference given in this RFP.
- f. Requirements for Joint Venture / Consortium Agreement (Bidder must meet the following mentioned requirements as following):
 - The documents should be signed by all Partners or Lead Partners and they should have valid Power of Attorney(s) duly signed by all members of the joint venture/consortium.
 - A joint venture/consortium should have valid agreement which delineates the rights and obligations of each member.
- g. Proof of Partnerships - MOUs/LOIs with selected executing partners (if applicable)
- h. Duly filled and signed Annexures as attached with this RFP

Bidder Expertise and Competency Requirements

- The bidder must be a firm/company that has been legally registered or incorporated for at least five (5) years, either in Pakistan or internationally; alternatively,
- Demonstrated experience in assignments related to development of strategic roadmaps of organizations including financial models specifically in the financial services space, with at least one similar assignment for an inclusive instant payment system/scheme
- The bidder must demonstrate direct, hands-on experience in the design, development, or deployment of at least one Inclusive Instant Payment System (IIPS) (e.g., UPI, Pix, Faster Payments, JoPACC, Saudi Payments), with clear evidence of its role and contributions in the engagement, especially on the strategy side. (Advisory-only, research-only, or benchmarking-only assignments will NOT be considered sufficient.)
- The bidder must have completed a minimum of three large-scale, similar assignments within the past three years involving the development of strategic roadmaps and financial models in the financial services sector, with specific reference/s provided that highlight both strategy development and implementation experience aligned

with the above requirement specifically of experience of implementation and strategy development of at least 1 inclusive instant payment scheme Client reference with verifiable contact details.

- Strong understanding of Pakistan’s business and regulatory environment, particularly as it pertains to financial and banking institutions.
- Proven expertise in developing strategic road maps, business plan and innovation strategies – with key focus in financial services domain.

3. Financial proposal

The financial proposal must be fully comprehensive, complete, and list any available discounts. Pricing information supplied with the proposal must be valid for at least 90 (ninety) days after the due date for proposal submission. All one-time and recurring costs must be fully described. Prices should be quoted, both inclusive and exclusive of all but showing separately, costs of inspection, services, transportation, Provincial/Federal taxes, import duties if any and other levies. Bidders shall accurately reflect all applicable taxes by specifying the exact percentage applicable under each tax category. Where a bidder is eligible for any tax exemption, relief or reduced withholding rate, including under an international double taxation treaty, the bidder must expressly disclose the same in its financial proposal, clearly identifying the relevant exemption, relief or treaty. Karandaaz Pakistan will not be responsible for any erroneous calculation of tax rates. All differences arising out as above shall be fully borne by the successful bidder. In case the bidder doesn’t identify inclusion of applicable taxes in the proposal, it shall be assumed that the quoted price is inclusive of all applicable taxes.

The financial proposal must be in-line and rationalized with the proposed implementation strategy submitted in the technical proposal corresponding to the scope of work given in this RFP.

Kindly submit signed and stamped copy of both the technical and financial proposals.

11 Currencies of Bid, Contract and Payment

The bids shall be submitted in PKR, or in USD provided that the bidder does not have an office or presence in Pakistan. The unit rates and prices quoted by the bidder in USD shall be converted into PKR using the prevailing rate of exchange published on the website of the State Bank of Pakistan, on the date of opening of financial bid. All the bids shall be evaluated in PKR.

Unless, mutually agreed between the parties otherwise:

- a. the successful bidder will be offered the contract in PKR and invoices shall be in PKR.
- b. However, if the successful bidder does not have an office in Pakistan, the invoices may be submitted in USD. Any invoice received in USD will be converted into PKR using the exchange rate locked in the contract and the payment will be made in USD.
- c. The cumulative payments to bidder whether in PKR or USD, using whatever exchange rate, shall not exceed the PKR amount agreed in the contract.

Karandaaz will pay the successful bidder’s invoice upon i) receipt of the invoice ii) approval from Karandaaz Pakistan of the successful bidder’s Deliverables. Payment will be made, as agreed, to the account specified in the successful bidder’s invoice within 30 days after the acceptance of deliverables, and submission of invoice subject to the State Bank of Pakistan’s approval for repatriation of funds.

12 Proposal Validity

Proposals shall remain valid for a minimum of ninety (90) days after the proposal submission deadline date established by Karandaaz Pakistan. A proposal valid for a shorter period shall be rejected as non-responsive.

In exceptional circumstances, prior to the expiration of the proposal validity period, Karandaaz Pakistan may request all bidders who have submitted their proposals to extend the period of validity of their proposal for a specified additional period. The request and the responses shall be made in writing. Agreement by a bidder to extend the validity of its proposal, shall be without any change in the original proposal and with confirmation of availability of the key experts. A bidder has the right to refuse extension in the validity period of its proposal, in which case such proposal will not be further evaluated.

If any of the key experts/resource becomes unavailable for the extended validity period, the relevant bidder shall provide an adequate justification in writing and evidence to the satisfaction of Karandaaz Pakistan together with the substitution request. In any such case, the replacement key expert shall have equal or better qualifications and experience than those of the originally proposed key expert. The technical evaluation score, however, will continue to be based on the evaluation of the CV of the original key expert.

If the said bidder fails to provide a replacement key expert with equal or better qualifications, or if the reasons provided for the replacement or justification are not to the reasonable satisfaction of Karandaaz Pakistan, the proposal will be rejected at Karandaaz Pakistan's sole discretion.

13 Proposal Security

A proposal security is not required for this procurement.

14 Alternative proposals

Alternative proposals shall not be considered.

15 Format, Signing, and Submission of Proposal

The bidder shall prepare and email a scanned copy of the documents comprising the proposal as specified in Clause 10 of Section 2 on its official letterhead. Each document shall be signed by a person duly authorized to sign on behalf of the bidder and all pages of the proposal shall be initialled by the person or persons signing the proposal.

The proposal shall contain no alterations or additions, other than those which are necessary for complying with instructions issued by Karandaaz Pakistan, or as are necessary for correcting errors made by the bidder, in which case such corrections shall be initialled by the person or persons signing the proposal.

16 Deadline for Submission of Proposals

Proposals must be received by Karandaaz Pakistan on or before **12th June 2026**.

Karandaaz Pakistan may extend the deadline for submission of proposals by issuing an amendment in accordance with Clause 8 of Section 2 'Amendment of RFP', in which case the original deadline shall be extended to the new deadline.

17 Late Proposal

Any proposal received after the deadline for the submission of proposals prescribed in Clause 16 of Section 2 by Karandaaz Pakistan will be considered only at the sole discretion of the evaluation team. Any decision by the evaluation team in this regard shall be deemed final.

18 Withdrawal, Substitution, and Modification of Proposal

Bidders may withdraw, substitute, or modify their proposal by giving notice in writing before the deadline for submission of proposal prescribed in Clause 16 of Section 2 'Deadline for Submission of Proposal'.

Each bidder's withdrawal, substitution, or modification notice shall be prepared, sealed, marked, and delivered in accordance with Clause 15 of Section 2 'Format, Signing, and Submission of Proposal', with the subject line: Responding to RFP for "Hiring of a Consulting Firm for Development of a Detailed Business Plan & Strategy for Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited (RPP)" "WITHDRAWAL," "SUBSTITUTION" or "MODIFICATION"] as appropriate. No proposal may be substituted or modified after the deadline for submission of proposal as mentioned in Clause 16 of Section 2.

D. Proposal Opening and Evaluation**19 Proposal Opening**

Karandaaz Pakistan shall open the proposals, including modifications made pursuant to Clause 18 of Section 2, on any day after the deadline stipulated in Clause 16 of Section 2 or the extended deadline in accordance with Clause 16 of Section 2, as the case may be.

20 Confidentiality

Information relating to the examination, evaluation, comparison, and post-qualification of proposal, and recommendation of contract award, shall not be disclosed to bidders or any other third persons whatsoever, prior to publication of the contract award. Any effort by a bidder to influence Karandaaz Pakistan in the examination, evaluation, comparison, and post-qualification of the proposal or contract award decision may result in the rejection of its bid. Notwithstanding the foregoing, from the time of proposal opening to the time of bidding process conclusion, if any bidder wishes to contact Karandaaz Pakistan on any matter related to the bidding process, it should do so in writing at the address indicated in Clause 7 of Section 2 'Clarification of RFP'.

21 Clarification of Bids

To assist in the examination, evaluation, and comparison of proposals, Karandaaz Pakistan may, at its discretion, seek clarifications in writing and/or through a presentation in respect of the proposal from any bidder. The request for clarification and the response shall be in writing, but no change in the price or substance of the proposal shall be sought, offered, or permitted except correction of arithmetical errors discovered by Karandaaz Pakistan in the evaluation of the proposals in accordance with Clause 26 of Section 2 'Correction of Errors'.

22 Preliminary Examination of Proposals

Prior to the detailed evaluation of proposals, Karandaaz Pakistan shall first review each proposal and check the power of attorney or any other form of delegation of authority demonstrating that the representative has been duly authorized to sign the proposal, initialization of all pages, etc.

23 Determination of Bidder's Eligibility and Qualifications

Karandaaz Pakistan's determination of a proposal's responsiveness shall be based on the contents of the proposal itself. A substantially responsive proposal is one, which conforms to all the terms, conditions, and specifications of the RFP, without material deviation or reservation. A material deviation or reservation is one (a) which affects in any substantial way the scope, quality, or performance of the Services; (b) which limits in any substantial way or is inconsistent with the RFP, Karandaaz Pakistan's potential rights or bidder's obligations under the proposed contract; or

(c) the rectification of which would unfairly affect the competitive position of other bidders presenting substantially responsive proposal.

24 Evaluation of Technical Proposal

Each proposal that meets all mandatory requirements and is not rejected for reasons stated in these instructions will be given a technical score.

The evaluation criteria, relevant sub-criteria, and point system to be used to evaluate the technical proposals shall be:

Proposal Evaluation Phase	Evaluation Methods	Evaluation Score
Technical Evaluation		
A.	Desk Review of Proposals	50
B.	Presentation of Proposals	20
C.	Finalization of Technical Evaluation Score	(A + B) = 70
Financial Evaluation		
D.	Evaluation of Financial Bids	30
Project Award		
E.	Finalization of Proposal Evaluation	(C + D) = 100

Desk Review of Proposal (50 points):

This is the first stage of the proposal evaluation process. Proposals will undergo a technical review by a technical evaluation committee. In the desk review phase, proposals will be evaluated against the following criteria:

High Level Criteria	Detailed Sub-Criteria	Score
Understanding of the scope	Demonstrated clear understanding of the project scope as defined in the Terms of Reference, along with a detailed grasp of the requirements, particularly in alignment with the strategy and business model deliverables outlined in the deliverables' tables.	08

Proposed methodology	Proposed methodology and approach for detailed business plan and strategy development for Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited, specifically for the deliverables mentioned for the strategy and business model development aligned with the requirements outlined in the Terms of Reference (TORs), including details on the approach taken to understand the local market, engagement with relevant players, international benchmarking , regulatory environment understanding, understanding of Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited operations etc.	12
Relevant Experience	• Relevant experience & references: Proven delivery of digital payments infrastructure/schemes with strong stakeholder collaboration; include at least 3 verifiable references covering strategic roadmaps, business plans, and financial models—preferably in financial services across local and international contexts. • Technical & commercial expertise: Deep expertise in instant payment ecosystems (scheme design, participant models, interoperability), along with pricing and revenue frameworks for digital infrastructure and governance models in multi-stakeholder environments (regulators, banks, fintechs, government). • Execution capability & local context: Ability to deliver implementation-ready, actionable roadmaps beyond high-level strategy; familiarity with Pakistan's financial and regulatory landscape is an added advantage.	15
Team Profile	The bidder shall submit a detailed proposed project team, including comprehensive profiles of key experts, clearly defining their roles, responsibilities, and allocation within the assignment. The team must collectively demonstrate the required technical depth and practical experience to deliver all aspects of the engagement. • Engagement Lead / Partner Minimum 15 years of professional experience with demonstrable leadership in complex financial services or payments engagements, including direct involvement in at least one Inclusive Instant Payment System (IIPS)-related assignment. • Payments Domain Expert(s) Proven expertise in instant payment systems with hands-on implementation experience (not limited to advisory roles), including scheme design, operational rollout, or system integration. • Financial Modelling Expert Strong experience in developing dynamic, scenario-based financial models, including revenue, cost, and sustainability	15

	modelling within financial services or digital infrastructure contexts. • Technology / Infrastructure Expert Demonstrated experience in designing and/or implementing payment system architectures across cloud, on-premise, or hybrid environments, with understanding of scalability, interoperability, and security requirements. Karandaaz reserves the right to review, approve, or reject any proposed team member and may require substitution where necessary to ensure optimal fit and capability for the assignment.	
	<i>a. Sub-Total: Desk Review of Technical Proposals</i>	50

A. Presentation

Proposals that attain a score of 35 and above out of 50 points in the desk review phase will proceed to the presentation stage. Bidding entities that qualify for the presentation stage will be invited to present their proposals in detail, addressing any concerns or questions posed by the evaluation committee. The presentation round will have a total score of 20 points. Bidders will be evaluated based on how well they present their proposals and respond to the concerns and questions posed by the technical evaluation committee. During the presentation stage, the score for the desk review may be revised based on the assessment of the technical evaluation committee.

B. Finalization of Technical Evaluation Score

Based on the presentation and the desk review of proposal, the final technical evaluation score will be determined, as depicted below:

Technical Evaluation	Score
Desk Review Stage	50
Presentation	20
Total	70

Bidders that achieve a combined score (Desk review + Presentation) of 55 points and above will progress to the financial evaluation stage.

25 Evaluation of Proposal Price and ranking:

Evaluation Criteria

The Evaluation will be conducted based on:

- Technical Proposal and Presentation (70 points); and
- Financial Proposal (30 points)

Financial Score to be calculated as:

Financial proposal submitted will be evaluated according to price reasonableness determination under full and open competition and known market conditions.

Evaluation of the financial proposal will consider, but will not be limited to, the following:

- Cost reasonableness;
- Consistency with the technical proposal

Note: The financial bid shall be evaluated on the total price proposed in the financial proposal.

30 points will be awarded to the lowest responsive bidder while rest of the bids will be allocated points according to the following formula:

Points of a Bidder = $(P1/ P2) * 30$

Where:

P1= Price of Lowest Responsive Bidder

P2= Price of the Bidder

Karandaaz Pakistan may also negotiate the price and terms & conditions with the short-listed/ highest (combined technical and financial) scored bidder to have best techno-commercial outcome. If the outcome of the negotiation is unsuccessful or an agreement is not reached with the top ranked bidder, Karandaaz may then negotiate with the next in-line bidder and so on down the list as per rank until a satisfactory outcome is achieved.

26 Correction of Errors

All proposals determined to be substantially responsive shall be checked by Karandaaz Pakistan for any arithmetical errors. Errors shall be corrected by Karandaaz Pakistan as follows:

Where there is a discrepancy between the amounts in figures and in words, the amount in words shall govern.

The amount stated in the proposal shall be adjusted by Karandaaz Pakistan in accordance with the above procedure for the correction of errors and, with the concurrence of the bidder, shall be considered as binding upon the bidder. If the bidder does not accept the corrected amount, the proposal shall be rejected.

27 Currency for Price Evaluation

For evaluation and comparison purposes, Karandaaz Pakistan shall convert all proposed prices expressed in USD into an equivalent amount in PKR, using the selling exchange rates established by the State Bank of Pakistan on the date of financial proposal opening specified in Clause 19 of Section 2 'Proposal Opening'.

E. Award of Contract

28 Award Criteria

Karandaaz Pakistan shall award the contract to the bidder whose proposal has been determined to be substantially responsive to the RFP and which has the highest combined technical and financial score and is most advantageous to Karandaaz.

29 Karandaaz Pakistan’s right to accept any Proposal and to reject any or all Proposals

Bidders whose bid is evaluated successful will be notified of award and unsuccessful bidders will also be intimated via regret emails. Karandaaz Pakistan shall observe a 7 calendar days standstill period after intimation of results. Standstill period is defined as the period to give Bidders time to assess whether it is appropriate to submit an inquiry/concern/complaint. In case a vendor inquiry about the results of the evaluation, only the scores of the inquiring party shall be shared.

Any inquiry received after the standstill period shall not be considered for any action.

Karandaaz Pakistan reserves the right to cancel the bidding process and to reject all bids or to accept or reject any bid, at any time prior to the award of contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected bidder or bidders or any obligation to inform the affected bidder or bidders of the grounds for Karandaaz Pakistan’s action.

30 Complaints pertaining to Bidding Process

Without prejudice to Clause 29 of Section 2, any complaint at any stage of the bidding process or on conclusion of the bidding process from a bidder regarding a deviation from the prescribed procurement procedure may be addressed and delivered in writing to:

Karandaaz Pakistan
Attention: Chief Executive Officer
1 E, Ali Plaza, Nazimuddin Road, D-Chowk, Islamabad

Any requests via email seeking this explanation should be sent to
proccomplaint@karandaaz.com.pk

31 Notification of Award and Signing of Agreement

The bidder whose proposal has been accepted shall be notified of the award by Karandaaz Pakistan prior to expiration of the proposal validity period through a communication in writing (the “Letter of Acceptance”). The said Letter of Acceptance shall state the full value of the contract payable by Karandaaz Pakistan in consideration of the services to be provided in accordance with the RFP.

The contract pursuant to the award shall incorporate all agreements between Karandaaz Pakistan and the successful bidder and shall be signed by Karandaaz Pakistan and sent to the successful bidder, anytime following the date of the Letter of Acceptance. The successful bidder will duly sign the contract and return it to Karandaaz Pakistan with seven (7) days of the receipt of the Letter of Acceptance.

SECTION 3. PROCUREMENT POLICY – BIDDER CONDUCT

32 Corrupt or fraudulent practices

Bidders, suppliers, contractors and their agents (whether declared or not), suppliers, and any personnel thereof, shall observe the highest standard of ethics during the procurement and execution of contracts.

Any effort by the bidder to influence Karandaaz Pakistan in the examination, evaluation, comparison, post-qualification of the proposals, or contract award decisions will result in the rejection of its proposal.

Karandaaz Pakistan shall not award the contract if it is determined that the bidder, or any of its personnel, or its agents, or its suppliers and/or their employees, has, directly or indirectly, engaged in corrupt, fraudulent, collusive, coercive, or obstructive practices in competing for the contract in question. As part of bidding/ solicitation documents, Karandaaz Pakistan will seek declaration of 'Non collusive non-corrupt practices' from each bidder. Format for such declaration is prescribed in Annexure B of the standard bidding document. In pursuance of this policy, following terms are defined as follows:

- a. "Corrupt practice" is the offering, giving, receiving, or soliciting, directly or indirectly, of anything of value to influence improperly the actions of another party;
- b. "Fraudulent practice" is any act or omission, including a misrepresentation, that knowingly or recklessly misleads, or attempts to mislead, a party to obtain a financial or other benefit or to avoid an obligation;
- c. "Collusive practice" is an arrangement between two or more parties designed to achieve an improper purpose, including to influence improperly the actions of another party;
- d. "Coercive practice" is impairing or harming, or threatening to impair or harm, directly or indirectly, any party or the property of the party to influence improperly the actions of a party;
- e. "Obstructive practice" is deliberately destroying, falsifying, altering, or concealing of evidence material to the investigation or making false statements to investigators in order to materially impede investigation into allegations of a corrupt, fraudulent, coercive or collusive practice; and/or threatening, harassing or intimidating any party to prevent it from disclosing its knowledge of matters relevant to the investigation or from pursuing the investigation.

Karandaaz Pakistan shall not award the contract if it's determined that the bidder or any of its personnel, agents or consortium partner - suppliers and/or their employees are directly or indirectly engaged in or support individuals, groups or entities associated with terrorism, including but not limited to the following:

- a. HM Treasury's Office of Financial Sanction Implementation-Financial sanctions consolidated list of targets;
- b. UK Home Office- Proscribed terrorist groups or organisations;
- c. United Nations- United Nations Security Council Sanctions List;
- d. World Bank- World Bank Listing of Ineligible Firms and Individuals.
- e. European Union- Consolidated List of Sanctions;
- f. Parties on US Treasury's Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) List of Specially Designated Nationals and Blocked Persons
- g. National Counter Terrorism Authority (NACTA)- Proscribed Organizations List;
- h. National Counter Terrorism Authority (NACTA)-Proscribed Persons List
- i. French DG Trésor Freeze Register Sanctions List

33 Avoidance of conflict of interest

Any bidder participating in the procurement process should disclose any actual or perceived conflict of interest situation/condition. Any bidder to have a conflict of interest shall be ineligible for award of a contract.

A bidder shall be considered to have a conflict of interest in a procurement process if:

- a. Such bidder is providing goods, works, or non-consulting services resulting from or directly related to consulting services for the preparation or implementation of a project that it provided or were provided by any affiliate that directly or indirectly controls, is controlled by, or is under common control with that bidder; or
- b. An entity can participate only in one bid: as a single bidder, as a lead in a consortium/ joint venture or as a partner in a consortium / joint venture. Partnership firms or similar entities in different jurisdiction which work under common brand name or a part of affiliated network will be regarded as single entity and may not participate in more than one bid. Similarly associates and subsidiaries of an entity will be regarded as a part of a group and may not participate in multiple bids. Bidders may ask for clarification and any decision in this regard by Karandaaz shall be deemed to be final.
- c. Such bidder (including its personnel) has a close business or family relationship with one or more professional staff of Karandaaz Pakistan who:
 - (i) is/are directly or indirectly involved in the preparation of the bidding documents or specifications of the contract, and/or the bid evaluation process of the contract; or
 - (ii) would be involved in the implementation or supervision of the contract unless the conflict stemming from such relationship has been resolved in a manner acceptable to Karandaaz Pakistan throughout the procurement process and execution of the contract; or
 - (iii) Such bidder falls under any other conflict of interest situation as specified in the standard bidding documents relevant to the specific procurement process.

34 Duty of Care

The successful bidder in performance of services for Karandaaz Pakistan shall exercise a duty of care. Duty of care holds the successful bidder responsible for the safety and well-being of its personnel and any third party affected by its activities.

35 Related Parties

Any bidder participating in the procurement process should disclose whether they are a Related Party of Karandaaz Pakistan.

Related Parties of Karandaaz Pakistan include:

- (i) a director or his / her relative,
- (ii) key managerial personnel or his relative;
- (iii) a firm, in which a director, manager or his relative is a partner;
- (iv) a private company in which a director or manager is a member or director;
- (v) a public company in which a director or manager is a director or holds along with his relatives, any shares of its paid-up share capital;

- (vi) any corporate whose chief executive or manager is accustomed to act in accordance with the advice, directions or instructions of a director or manager;
- (vii) any person on whose advice, directions, or instructions a director or manager is accustomed to act:
Provided that nothing in sub-clauses (vi) and (vii) shall apply to the advice, directions or instructions given in a professional capacity;
- (viii) any company which is a holding, subsidiary, or an associated company of Karandaaz Pakistan; or a subsidiary of a holding company to which Karandaaz Pakistan is also a subsidiary;
- (ix) such other person as may be specified.

Here relative is taken to mean: the spouse, siblings, lineal ascendants, and descendants of a person.

It is the policy of Karandaaz Pakistan that transactions with related parties shall be on purely commercial terms. There will not be any undue consideration given to such transactions.

In case bidder is a Related Party, following minimum information will be required to be provided alongside the proposal for use by the relevant approval body at Karandaaz Pakistan. Bidder acknowledges that Karandaaz Pakistan may also require additional information not listed below.

- I Names of the interested or concerned persons or directors
- II Nature of relationship, interest or concern along with complete information of financial or other interest or concern of directors, managers or key managerial personnel in the related party
- III Any other relevant and material information that is necessary for the body to make a well-informed decision regarding the approval of related party transactions

The bidder acknowledges that Karandaaz Pakistan may have a separate approval process for its transactions with Related Parties. The bidder further acknowledges that Karandaaz Pakistan is obligated to maintain a register of its transactions with Related Parties, and may disclose this information where required, including, but not limited to, its annual accounts.

SECTION 4. TERMS OF REFERENCE

Project Title:	Hiring of a Consulting Firm for Development of a Detailed Business Plan & Strategy for Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited (RPP)
Programme:	Karandaaz Digital
Expected Start Date:	July 2026
Expected End Date:	Feb 2027

About Karandaaz

KARANDAAZ PAKISTAN, a not-for-profit company established in 2014 and registered with the Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan under section 42, is promoting access to finance for small businesses through commercially directed investments and financial inclusion of individuals by leveraging technology-enabled solutions and platforms. Karandaaz has financial and institutional support from leading international development finance institutions; principally the United Kingdom's Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office (FCDO) and the Gates Foundation (GF). Karandaaz Pakistan operates through four program verticals:

- **Karandaaz Capital** provides wholesale structured credit and equity-linked direct growth capital investments in micro, small and mid-size enterprises (MSMEs) with compelling prospects for sustainable growth and employment generation in Pakistan
- **Karandaaz Digital** focuses on expanding access to digital financial services in Pakistan by working across the ecosystem with all stakeholders including regulators, policy-makers, government departments, businesses and researchers and academics in four key work areas: policy and regulation, seeding innovation, experimentation and solutions development, and scale and outreach.
- **Karandaaz Innovation** provides risk capital and technical assistance to support innovative and practicable solutions aimed at financial inclusion and entrepreneurship. The Women Ventures business line provides business development support and growth capital to women-led businesses to facilitate their expansion and scale-up.
- **Karandaaz Research & Insights** supports the company's core objectives by developing and disseminating evidence-based insights and solutions to inform and influence markets and the financial ecosystem.

Project Background and Rationale

Raast is Pakistan's national instant payment system, launched by the State Bank of Pakistan (SBP) in 2021 as the country's first government-backed, real-time digital payments platform. Conceived as a core **Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI)**, Raast is designed to serve as a **public good**, enabling secure, high-volume, and low-cost digital transactions for individuals, businesses, and government entities. Its open and interoperable architecture ensures inclusive, affordable access across the financial ecosystem, helping to remove key barriers such as high scheme fees, delayed settlements, and limited interoperability.

The system connects a diverse range of stakeholders — commercial and microfinance banks, Electronic Money Institutions (EMIs), Payment System Operators (PSOs), fintechs, government agencies, merchants, and consumers — and supports real-time transfers through simple mechanisms such as aliases and QR codes. It is already operational for:

- **Person-to-Person (P2P)** transfers
- **Government-to-Person (G2P)** disbursements

- **Person-to-Merchant (P2M)** payments, which hold transformative potential for digitizing retail commerce, reducing cash dependency, and advancing financial inclusion, especially for small and micro enterprises.

Guided by international best practices and the Level One principle, Raast is underpinned by:

1. Real-time, instant settlement
2. Full interoperability across the sector
3. Adoption of ISO 20022 global standards
4. High levels of reliability and security

Since launch, Raast has processed transactions exceeding PKR 89 trillion (as of 28th Feb 2026). However, Pakistan’s economy remains heavily cash-dependent - underscoring the continued importance of scaling Raast adoption to advance digitization and formalization.

To manage Raast’s operations and accelerate its growth, SBP has established **Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited** (hereinafter referred to as “**RPP**”), a wholly owned subsidiary incorporated under the Companies Act, 2017 and set up pursuant to Section 8A of the SBP Act, 2022. RPP has been tasked with safeguarding Raast’s **public good mandate**, while leveraging dedicated talent and operational independence to foster rapid innovation.

Modeled on successful global precedents such as UPI (India), PIX (Brazil), FAST (Singapore), JoPACC (Jordan), and Saudi Payments, RPP is positioned to catalyze instant payments adoption at scale, enabling broader innovation, financial inclusion, and sustainable growth of Pakistan’s digital economy.

To realize this vision, RPP requires a comprehensive **business plan** that defines its organizational strategy, operating model, long-term sustainability, infrastructure scale, governance and growth roadmap. Through these Terms of References, Karandaaz Pakistan seeks to engage an experienced consulting firm with proven expertise in digital payment systems, financial infrastructure institutions, and business strategy to develop this business plan.

Project Objectives

The overall objective of this assignment is to develop a detailed Business Plan/Strategy Roadmap for RPP, which would include the following:

- Recommend the vision for RPP, detailed mission statement and clear strategic objectives.
- A strategic framework for RPP’s positioning within Pakistan’s payments ecosystem.
- A detailed 3-year strategy roadmap that identifies potential customer segments, products/use cases, operating model considerations, and financial models, and sustainability mechanisms, while keeping in mind the key principles that this entity is built on being a “public good”.
- Develop a detailed implementation plan that defines clear phases, timelines, and responsibilities, supported by measurable KPIs, well-defined milestones, and success metrics to track progress, ensure accountability, and evaluate the effectiveness and impact of the strategy over time.
- Provide recommendations for establishing sustainable operating models that ensure long-term financial viability, operational efficiency, and scalability by defining governance structures, funding mechanisms, resource allocation, and continuous improvement processes aligned with evolving business and technology needs.

- Define a comprehensive technical strategy to determine the optimal deployment model (cloud, on-premises, or hybrid) based on usage forecasts, cost efficiency, and practical payment models.
- Define governance and participation models that reinforce resilience and ensure competitive neutrality by establishing transparent decision-making structures, equitable stakeholder engagement, clear accountability, and policies that prevent vendor lock-in while enabling fair access and adaptability across deployment options
- Develop a comprehensive roadmap for innovation, adoption, and ecosystem development that outlines phased initiatives to introduce new capabilities, drive stakeholder onboarding, and expand partnerships, while incorporating a targeted merchant acquisition and usage acceleration strategy through incentives, awareness programs, seamless integration options, and data-driven engagement to ensure sustained growth and network effects.
- Benchmark business model and strategic direction for RPP against international best practices (e.g., UPI, FAST, PIX, JoPACC, Saudi Payments and other similar instant payment schemes/systems).

Project Scope of Work

The successful bidder will be required to undertake the following:

- **Strategic Positioning & Market Assessment**
 - Review RPP’s mandate, legal framework, and State Bank of Pakistan’s objectives.
 - Assess Pakistan’s digital payments landscape, opportunities, and challenges.
 - Engage with relevant stakeholders—including banks, EMIs, PSPs, fintechs, merchants, regulators, and government entities—to assess their readiness and gather insights on their capabilities, constraints, and strategic priorities, in order to understand diverse perspectives on the future outlook, identify opportunities for growth and collaboration, and surface key challenges that may impact implementation and adoption.
 - Benchmarking conducted against relevant global instant payment operators e.g., UPI, Pix, Faster Payments, JoPACC, Saudi Payments, SEPA), covering their inception, growth strategy, roadmaps, and current status, and must explicitly identify the exact decisions taken by these systems, what worked and what failed, what elements are transferable to the Pakistan context, and what should not be replicated.
- **Business & Operating Model Development**

Provide recommendations on governance, operating, and business models that ensure institutional independence, operational efficiency, and scalability by defining clear roles, decision-making frameworks, performance accountability, and sustainable revenue structures that can adapt to evolving market and regulatory dynamics.
- **Financial Model & Sustainability**
 - **Determine revenue and funding KPIs and structures:** Define revenue and funding mechanisms—including investments, service income, value-added offerings, and strategic partnerships—ensuring that core services remain a public good and that infrastructure prioritizes broad societal benefit. Establish KPIs aligned with maintaining free access to basic transaction sets in the near term, while capturing sustainable revenue from complementary streams.

- **Prepare a 3-year revenue and funding plan:** Develop a detailed three-year plan incorporating both revenue streams and cost drivers, with clearly stated assumptions. Include estimates of market size, potential adoption and penetration rates, and forecasted revenues and expenditures. Deliver the forecast in a structured format (i.e. Excel Model) suitable for scenario modeling and decision-making.
- **Conduct sensitivity analysis and sustainability assessment:** Analyze how variations in key assumptions—such as adoption rates, transaction volumes, and cost fluctuations—impact revenue sustainability and financial viability. Provide recommendations to mitigate risks and ensure long-term operational sustainability.
- **Develop a phased implementation plan:** Create a roadmap for execution with clear short-term, medium-term, and long-term phases, outlining priority initiatives, timelines, responsibilities, and dependencies to ensure smooth rollout and adoption.
- **Identify KPIs and performance monitoring mechanisms:** Define measurable KPIs to track financial performance, adoption, service quality, and operational efficiency. Recommend monitoring frameworks and reporting processes to enable continuous assessment, accountability, and course correction.

- **Strategy Roadmap – Report deliverables**

For each strategic area (including business model, governance, technology, operating model, and related domains), the consultant shall undertake a comprehensive assessment of multiple strategic options to ensure robustness of analysis; however, only one clearly recommended strategy shall be presented. This recommendation must be supported by strong analytical justification, explicitly outlining key trade-offs, associated risks, expected outcomes, and practical implementation implications. The consultant shall also provide a detailed, step-by-step execution plan, including defined timelines, responsibilities, and critical milestones to ensure accountable delivery.

All deliverables must be fully integrated and internally consistent, with clear linkages across all strategic components that are given below. Outputs must go beyond conceptual recommendations and include clear action-level detailing, defined ownership using a RACI framework, identified decision checkpoints, and a comprehensive mapping of internal and external dependencies.

Respective strategic areas are given below:

- **Product and Innovation Strategy - Use case & adoption strategy:**
 - Define scope of services for RPP, clearly defining the market needs that RPP will solve and clearly articulating the areas which are necessary but RPP will not take up (In-scope and Out-of-Scope services). A clear product and innovation strategy with roadmap to be shared for the instant payment scheme.
 - Clearly identify and define the requisites/dependencies from ecosystem players to achieve the strategy roadmap
 - Clearly identify external dependencies on the regulators and government departments to achieve the business plan
 - Clearly define and execute initiatives to drive market development through targeted merchant acquisition pilots, consumer incentivization, and ongoing product experimentation, while supporting the Regulatory Sandbox with a focus on remittances, open banking, and merchant onboarding.

- In parallel, detail out a comprehensive growth strategy with implementation plan to increase usage by combining continuous innovation, targeted awareness campaigns, and well-structured incentives that promote adoption, enhance user experience, and sustain long-term engagement across all stakeholder segments.
- Brand strategy closely linked to usage growth by designing targeted awareness programs that build trust, clearly communicate value propositions, and drive behavioral change, ultimately translating brand recognition into increased adoption and sustained usage.
- **Technical Strategy:**
 - Comprehensive technical strategy to determine the optimal deployment model (cloud, on-premises, or hybrid) based on usage forecasts, cost efficiency, and practical payment models.
- **Operational Strategy**
 - Comprehensive review of the organization's operational framework and provide recommendations for an operational strategy that ensures efficiency, consistency, and excellence by optimizing processes, enhancing resource utilization, implementing performance monitoring, and embedding continuous improvement practices.
- **Participation Governance Model**
 - Define governance and participation models that reinforce resilience and ensure competitive neutrality by establishing transparent decision-making structures, equitable stakeholder engagement, clear accountability, and policies enabling fair access and adaptability across deployment options. Related to the participants of the instant payment scheme – could include banks, fintechs, payment processors, public/private organization and/or any other entity.
- **Talent Strategy**
 - Provide recommendations on talent strategy and capacity building that focus on attracting, developing, and retaining the right skills, establishing structured training programs, fostering knowledge transfer, and creating a scalable workforce capable of supporting current operations and future growth objectives.
- **Regulatory and Compliance Model**
 - Provide an assessment of potential regulatory and compliance related support that will be required for the sustainability of the organization.

Project Governance Structure

The successful bidder shall establish and adhere to a structured Project Governance and Engagement Framework to ensure continuous alignment, transparency, and implementation-focused delivery throughout the duration of the assignment. This framework shall mandate active participation from all key stakeholders and prevent gaps between analysis and execution. Before the engagement is initiated, a formal project kick-off meeting will be held preferably on-site.

A Steering Committee shall be constituted to provide strategic oversight and direction. The Steering Committee shall meet on a monthly basis and shall be responsible for reviewing progress, resolving critical issues, and formally approving key deliverables and milestones.

A dedicated Working Group comprising a core team and the successful bidder shall be established to enable close collaboration and co-creation. This group shall engage on at least a fortnightly basis (on-

site or online), with full access to underlying analyses, models, assumptions, and draft outputs to ensure alignment and iterative refinement.

A formal Stage-Gate Approval Mechanism shall be implemented, whereby each phase of the assignment is subject to review and written approval before progression to the subsequent phase. No milestone shall be deemed complete without documented sign-off.

All deliverables under this engagement must be implementation-ready and include detailed action-level specifications (not conceptual recommendations), clearly defined ownership using a RACI framework, explicit decision-making checkpoints, identification of internal and external dependencies, relevant regulatory triggers, and a comprehensive assessment of execution risks along with proposed mitigation measures. For the presentation of all final deliverables of each stage, the successful bidder is expected to have its team present on-site to engage in discussions and share insights with the Steering Committee.

Project Timeline and Deliverables

The section details the chronology of how key activities are expected to be rolled out over a duration of 12 months. The timeline (indicative), deliverable and payment schedule for the project is provided in the table below:

Deliverable	Description	Tentative Timeline & Payment*
1	Detailed inception report and engagement plan, with list of possible headers for the strategy report with basic assumptions to be taken for the development of the business plan – financial model	10% of total contract value (Month 1)
2	Submission and acceptance of a comprehensive report covering a detailed overview of RPP's current operations, including its vision, mission, and strategic objectives; a structured assessment of current challenges and market dynamics; and benchmarking of relevant international models supported by case studies. The benchmarking analysis must explicitly identify what has worked, what has failed, what is transferable to the Pakistan context, and what should not be replicated. The deliverable must provide clear, implementation-oriented insights with direct implications for RPP's strategy, ensuring all findings are actionable and decision-relevant.	10% of total contract value (Month 2)
3	Submission and acceptance of Product and Innovation Strategy - Use case & adoption strategy	15% of total contract value (Month 3)
4	Submission and acceptance of technical strategy	15% of total contract value (Month 4)
5	Submission and acceptance of operational, participation governance, talent and regulatory/compliance strategy report	15% of total contract value (Month 5)
6	Submission and acceptance of business model with detailed excel model for 3 years	15% of total contract value

		(Month 6)
7	Approved, implementation-ready report and presentation for the RPP board - including a detailed business plan and execution playbook covering the first 12 months (post engagement completion) , decision calendar, governance workflows, stakeholder engagement plan, and regulatory roadmap.	20% of total contract value (Month 6)

***Note:**

-This is a tentative flow of work and timeline, however the proposals will need to showcase their detailed workplans with effective reporting and timelines.

The Bidder:

Karandaaz intends to solicit proposals from consultancy firms/companies and/or joint ventures/consortiums.

- Individuals who are nationals, permanent residents of India or Israel, or who originate from India and/or Israel will not be engaged for the project team or project steering team.
- Bidders which are based in India and/or Israel or in countries against which the U.S. maintains a comprehensive embargo are not eligible to participate in the RFP.
- The successful bidder must comply with all relevant laws, rules and regulations prevailing under Pakistani Laws.
- The responses submitted by the bidder to the RFP represents a firm offer to contract on the terms and condition described herein.
- The proposal must be signed by the authorized person(s), according to the laws of the jurisdiction of its incorporation/registration and according to the laws of Pakistan, to commit the bidder to the terms and conditions of the RFP, who shall have full authority to sign the proposal documents on behalf of all the bidders/members of the joint venture/consortium.
- The bidder must disclose at the earliest of any actual or potential conflict of interest with Karandaaz Pakistan as referenced above.
- The members of the joint venture/consortium shall be jointly and severally liable to Karandaaz Pakistan for the execution of the Project in accordance with the terms of the RFP document and a statement to this effect shall be included in the joint venture/consortium agreement, which should be submitted with the proposal.
- The bidder shall be deemed to have carefully examined the RFP document to its satisfaction. Any lack of information shall not in any way relieve the bidder of its responsibility to fulfil their obligations under the RFP.

Submission Guidelines

Each set of documents should be submitted separately in sealed envelopes and then included in a larger sealed package. This larger package must be mailed and emailed (soft copies) to the following postal address no later than 12th June, 2026. Following sets shall be submitted:

- i) Pre-qualification documents
- ii) Technical Proposal
- iii) Financial Proposal

- Office Address: 1 E, Ali Plaza, Nazim ud din Road, D-Chowk, Islamabad, Pakistan
- Email: procurement@karandaaz.com.pk
- **Envelops should be clearly marked:** RFP-185 Hiring of a Consulting Firm for Development of a Detailed Business Plan & Strategy for Raast Payments Pakistan (Pvt.) Limited (RPP)

SECTION 5. GUIDING PRINCIPLES ON CONTRACT TERMS AND CONDITIONS

1. Introduction

The following section contains highly preferred guiding principles of the contractual terms and conditions, which the successful bidder should adhere to. Please note that the detailed terms & conditions will be finalized during the contracting phase with the selected bidder.

2. The Bidder

- 2.1. The successful bidder must comply with all relevant laws, rules and regulations prevailing under Pakistani Laws.
- 2.2. The responses submitted by the bidder to the RFP represents a firm offer to contract on the terms and condition described herein.
- 2.3. The proposal must be signed by the authorized person, according to the laws of the jurisdiction of its incorporation/registration and according to the laws of Pakistan, to commit the bidder to the terms and conditions of the RFP, who shall have full authority to sign the proposal documents on behalf of all the bidders/members of the joint venture/consortium.
- 2.4. The bidder must disclose at the earliest of any actual or potential conflict of interest with Karandaaz Pakistan as referenced above.
- 2.5. The members of the joint venture shall be jointly and severally liable to Karandaaz Pakistan for the execution of the Services in accordance with the terms of the RFP document and a statement to this effect shall be included in the joint venture agreement, which should be submitted with the Proposal.
- 2.6. The bidder shall be deemed to have carefully examined the RFP document to its satisfaction. Any lack of information shall not in any way relieve the bidder of its responsibility to fulfil their obligations under the RFP.

3. Ownership of Intellectual Property Rights

- 3.1. All documents, supplies, developments, know how, materials, and related documents to the Services which are made and used by the successful bidder during the course of the project (Intellectual Property Rights) related thereto shall be assigned irrevocably and exclusively to Karandaaz Pakistan.
- 3.2. The successful bidder shall assign these Intellectual Property Rights referred to in Clause 4.1 above to Karandaaz Pakistan for unlimited and unfettered use for or purpose whatsoever, and without any limitations whatsoever.
- 3.3. The successful bidder shall from the date of signing the contract and until the end of its term do all such things that may be necessary or desirable to vest in Karandaaz Pakistan the full benefit of the items and Intellectual Property Rights referred to in Clause 4.1 and shall deliver up to Karandaaz Pakistan all such items as referenced in Clause 4.1 herein above.

- 3.4. The lead successful bidder shall ensure that all members of the joint venture/consortium are employed or engaged on terms that are consistent with the provisions of Clause 4.1 above and that the lead successful bidder and the joint venture/consortium members waive all moral rights in respect of the items referred to in Clause 4.1.

4. Fraud, Corruption and Terrorism

- 4.1. Karandaaz Pakistan will have zero tolerance approach towards fraud and fraudulent behavior during the procurement process and the implementation of the project itself and will reject a proposal for award if it determines that the lead bidder or any of the agents, suppliers or any personnel recommended for an award have engaged in Corrupt, Fraudulent, Collusive, Coercive and Obstructive Practices as referenced in Clause 32 of Section 3.
- 4.2. The bidders must immediately and without undue delay inform Karandaaz Pakistan of any event that interferes or threatens to materially interfere with the successful implementation of this RFP or the contract, including credible suspicion of the actual fraud, bribery, corruption, or any other irregularity or impropriety.
- 4.3. The bidder must immediately and without undue delay inform Karandaaz Pakistan if it or any of its employees, agents, suppliers, or policies are inconsistent with the United Nations Security Council resolutions or if the same has been blacklisted by any organization, institution, Government or regulatory body anywhere in the world.
- 4.4. Karandaaz Pakistan may at any time during the procurement process or after successful procurement and during the lifetime of the contract and thereafter up to a period of five year arrange for additional audits, on the spot checks and or/inspections to be carried out if they suspect Corrupt, Fraudulent, Collusive, Coercive and Obstructive Practices.
- 4.5. Karandaaz Pakistan will have zero tolerance approach towards terrorism and shall not award the contract and cancel the procurement if it is determined that the bidder or any of its personnel, agents or suppliers and or/their employees are, directly or indirectly engaged in or support individuals, groups or entities associated with terrorism, including but not limited to the following:
- HM Treasury's Office of Financial Sanctions Implementation-Financial sanctions consolidated list of targets;
 - UK Home Office- Proscribed terrorist groups or organizations;
 - European Union- Consolidated list of sanctions;
 - United Nations- United Nations Security Council Sanctions List
 - World Bank- World Bank Listing of Ineligible Firms and Individuals.
 - French DG Trésor Freeze Register Sanctions List

The bidder will not use funds provided under the contract directly or indirectly in support of activities (a) prohibited by US laws related to combatting terrorism (b) with or related to parties on the List of

Specially Designated Nationals (www.treasury.gov/sdn); or (c) with or related to the countries against which the U.S. maintains a comprehensive embargo (currently, Cuba, Iran, (North) Sudan, Syria, and North Korea). Unless such activities are fully authorized by the U.S. government under applicable laws and specifically approved by Karandaaz at its sole discretion.

5. Subcontractor

The successful bidder shall not utilize the services of any subcontractor as part of the contract.

6. Order Cancellation

6.1. Karandaaz Pakistan reserves the right to cancel the contract in the event of one or more of the following situations:

- a. Delay in provision of Services for the project beyond the specified period as set out in the contract;
- b. Serious discrepancy in the quality of service;
- c. If the successful lead bidder, its joint venture members, agent, employees or any other personnel make any statement, submit any information or enclose any form which turns out to be false, incorrect and or misleading and or conceals or suppresses material information in relation to the project;
- d. If the successful lead bidder, its joint venture members, or any of their agents, employees or any other personnel do not comply with the necessary laws, regulations, licenses or certifications.
- e. If the successful lead bidder, its joint venture members, agents, employees or any other personnel do not comply with Clause 5 above.

7. Compliance with applicable laws:

7.1. The successful bidder shall undertake to observe, adhere to, abide by, comply with and notify Karandaaz Pakistan about all laws, already in force as are made applicable in the future, pertaining to or applicable to them, their business, their employees or their obligations towards them and all purposes of this project. The successful bidder shall keep indemnified, hold harmless, defend and protect Karandaaz Pakistan, its officers, staff, agents and representatives from any omission on its part to do so and against all claims or demands of liability and all consequences that may occur or arise for any default or failure on its part to conform or comply with laws and all other statutory obligations arising there from.

7.2. The successful bidder shall promptly and timely obtain all such consents, permission, approvals or licenses as may be necessary or required for any of the purpose of the project or for the conduct of their own business under any applicable laws; regulations, rules, guidelines and shall keep the same valid and in force during the term of the project and in the event of any failure or omission to do so, shall indemnify, keep indemnified, hold harmless, defend, project and fully

compensate Karandaz Pakistan and its employees, officers, staff, personnel, representatives, agents from and against all claims or demands of liability and all consequences that may occur or arise for any default of liability and all consequences that may occur or arise for any default or failure on its part to conform or comply with the above and all other statutory obligations arising there from and Karandaz Pakistan will give notice of any such claim or demand of liability within reasonable time to the bidder.

- 7.3. In case the successful bidder deploys any employee, personnel, agent or consultant for the Services who is an overseas national, the successful bidder shall be solely responsible for obtaining all security clearances, registrations, and approvals required under applicable laws.

8. Representations and Warranties

- 8.1. The successful bidder shall represent and warrant to Karandaz Pakistan as follows:

- a. The proposal is signed by the authorized person, according to the laws of Pakistan, to commit the bidder to the terms and conditions of the RFP who has full authority to sign the proposal documents and execute the contracts on behalf of all bidder/members in the joint venture/consortium;
- b. It will not contravene any provision of its documents of incorporation by submitting its proposal under this RFP;
- c. It and its joint venture members, agents, suppliers or employees will not violate or contravene any law, rule, regulation, licensing requirement, order, writ, injunction or decree of any court, governmental instrumentality or other regulatory, governmental or public body, agency or authority by which it is bound or by which any of its properties or assets are bound;
- d. It and its joint venture members, agents, suppliers or employees possess the skills, experience, expertise and ability to undertake and fulfill their obligation under all provisions of this RFP;
- e. Any services, functions or responsibilities not specifically described in this RFP which form an inherent or necessary part of the deliverables or are required for the provision of the deliverables or services shall be deemed to be included as part of the deliverables and will be provided by the successful bidder at no additional cost to Karandaz Pakistan;
- f. The entry into and performance according to this RFP by the successful bidder will not breach any contractual or other obligation owed by the successful bidder to any other third party or any rights of any third party or any other legal provision;
- g. It and its joint venture members, agents, suppliers or employees will obtain and maintain all appropriate registrations, approvals, licenses and permissions that are statutorily required to be obtained by the successful bidder during the course of the project;
- h. It and its joint venture members, agents or employees shall not infringe any of the Intellectual Property Rights of any third parties during the provision of services for the project;
- i. It and its agents, suppliers or employees neither have nor will engage in money laundering, terrorist financing, weapon smuggling, anti-state activities and neither have nor will maintain

links with proscribed organizations including but not limited to the organizations, individuals, firms in the List of HM Treasury's Office of Financial Sanctions Implementations, UK Home Office's Proscribed Terrorist Group and Organizations, European Union's Consolidated list of Sanction, United Nations Security Council Sanctions List and the World Bank's list of Ineligible Firms and Individual;

- j. It shall timely and diligently participate in all meetings required by Karandaaz Pakistan;
 - k. It and its joint venture members, agents, suppliers and employees shall observe the highest standard of ethics during the term of the contract;
 - l. It shall exercise duty or care for the safety and wellbeing of its joint venture members, employees, and consultants, any personnel assigned to perform the services for the project.
- 8.2. Each of the representation and warranty set out in Clause 9.1 shall be construed as a separate representation and warranty and shall not be limited or restricted by reference to, or interference from, the terms of any other representation or warranty in the RFP or contract.
- 8.3. If at any time Karandaaz Pakistan becomes aware that a representation or warranty given by it under Clause 9.1 has been breached, has become untrue or has become misleading, it shall without undue delay notify Karandaaz Pakistan of the relevant occurrence in sufficient detail to enable Karandaaz Pakistan to make an accurate assessment of the situation.

9. Indemnity

- 9.1. The successful bidder shall indemnify, protect and hold Karandaaz Pakistan harmless from and against all claims, losses, costs, damages, expenses (including reasonable attorney fees) relating to or resulting directly from:
- a. An act or omission of the lead successful bidder, its joint venture members, its employees, its agents, suppliers in the execution of the project under this RFP;
 - b. Misappropriation of any third-party trade secrets or infringement of any of the Intellectual Property Rights or such other statutory infringements in respect of all components provided to fulfill the scope of the project;
 - c. Claims made by successful bidder's joint venture members, employees who are employed by the successful bidder under the contract;
 - d. Breach of confidentiality obligations of the successful bidder's joint venture members, agents, suppliers and employees;
 - e. Gross negligence or gross misconduct solely attributable to the successful bidder/joint venture members or by any agency, supplier, contractor, or any of their employees by the successful bidder for the purpose of any or all of the obligations under the contract;

- f. Any loss of data, loss of life etc. due to the successful bidder's joint venture members, employees, supplier and agents and not just arising out of gross negligence of misconduct;
- g. An act of omission or commission in performance of the services under the contracts;

10. Records and Inspection

- 10.1. The successful bidder shall complete, accurate and up-to-date records of all activities carried out by it in relation to and for the purposes of providing its Services required for compliance by Karandaaz Pakistan with all applicable laws or the requirements of the regulatory authorities under the laws of Pakistan.
- 10.2. The successful bidder shall at the request of Karandaaz Pakistan and upon reasonable notice allow duly authorized representatives of Karandaaz Pakistan, any regulatory authority or Karandaaz Pakistan's external auditor to inspect, copy and/or audit the Records and or the manner of provision of the services and to enter upon the successful bidders premises for these purposes during normal working hours, under the supervision of the successful bidder for the purpose of confirming compliance with the RFP.
- 10.3. The successful bidder shall provide Karandaaz Pakistan, the regulatory authority or its external auditors with such further assistance as they may reasonably require, provided that it does not materially affect the successful bidder's ability to provide the services in the normal course.

11. Confidential Information

- 11.1. Any information whether or not marked as such which is disclosed by Karandaaz Pakistan to the successful bidder or the successful bidder to the Karandaaz Pakistan either orally or in writing or by any other means, under or in connection with this RFP ("Confidential Information"), shall at all times from the date of disclosure till perpetuity:
 - a. Not be disclosed to any third party without the express approval of Karandaaz Pakistan;
 - b. Not be used for any purpose other than as contemplated by terms of this RFP and the contracts;
 - c. Not be made copies of or recorded in any way or part with its possession of any document containing or recording any Confidential Information;

- d. Ensure that the successful bidder's employees, suppliers or agents does any act which if done by that party would be a breach of the provisions of this Clause 12.1.

11.2. The successful bidder may disclose any Confidential Information of Karandaaz Pakistan to:

- a. Its joint venture member, client, employee or agent provided an undertaking is first obtained;
- b. A regulatory authority to which it is required to disclose the Confidential Information in questions; or
- c. Any employee or officer of the Karandaaz Pakistan or any of the persons mentioned in (a) and (b) above.

To the extent only that the disclosure is necessary for the purposes of performing its obligations its obligations or exercising or enforcing its rights under the RFP and contracts, and in each case subject to that party first informing the person in question that the Confidential Information is confidential and (except where the disclosure is to a regulatory authority or any employee or officer of any such body) obtaining and submitting to the other party a written under-taking from the person in question, as nearly as practicable in the terms of this clause, to keep the Confidential Information confidential and to use it only for the purposes for which disclosure is made.

11.3. Upon termination of the contract for any reason, the successful bidder shall cease to use, and shall forthwith deliver up to Karandaaz Pakistan or destroy any document or control containing or recording any Confidential Information in respect in which the successful bidder has a continuing obligation under Clause 12.1.

12. Penalties for Delay

Karandaaz Pakistan can levy a penalty for up to 0.5% of the total contract value (per week up to a limit of 10% of the total contract value in case of late delivery against mutually agreed timelines. Karandaaz Pakistan has the right to cancel the order in case the penalty exceeds 5% of the contract value. Only delays directly attributable to the successful bidder would invoke such penalties.

13. Force Majeure

13.1. The successful bidder and Karandaaz Pakistan will not be liable for any act, omission or failure to fulfill its obligation under the contracts. If such act, omission or failure arises from an event of force majeure, i.e. a natural disaster, act of God, coup, strike, lock out etc. The party un-able to fulfill its obligations will notify the other without undue delay in writing of the reasons for its failure to fulfill its obligations due to the force majeure, any damage or loss caused (or likely to be caused) and any proposed remedial action.

- 13.2. The successful bidder and Karandaaz Pakistan will agree on the extent of any such damage and loss and any remedial action and will, if necessary, vary the timeline for the completion of the project accordingly.

14. Termination

Karandaaz Pakistan may at any time terminate the agreement without assigning any reason by giving a 30-days' notice of termination. The Parties agree that Karandaaz Pakistan shall compensate the successful bidder for the Services rendered up to the effective date of termination only for such services which shall be completed, in the sole decision of Karandaaz, by more than 50 %.

15. Arbitration

- 15.1. All disputes, differences or questions with respect to any matter arising out of or relating to the project shall be resolved by both the successful bidder and Karandaaz Pakistan through mutual negotiations in good faith. Either party may inform each other about any such dispute through a notice in writing specifying the issue in dispute or the matter of difference, within fifteen (15) days following receipt of such a notice the successful bidder and Karandaaz Pakistan shall endeavor to settle the issue through amicable negotiations. In case the issue raised through the notice cannot be settled within the period of fifteen (15) days from the date of issuance of notice with respect there to, the issue or matter shall be referred to Arbitration as provided in Clause 16.2.
- 15.2. The Arbitration shall be conducted in accordance to the Arbitration Act 1940. Arbitration proceedings shall be conducted by a sole arbitrator appointed by mutual agreement. The decision of the arbitrator shall be final and binding on the Parties. The venue for arbitration shall be Islamabad, Pakistan and the language for arbitration proceedings shall be English

Annexure - A

PROPOSAL SUBMISSION FORM

Dear Sir/Madam,

Having examined the Solicitation Documents, the receipt of which is hereby duly acknowledged, "THE FIRM NAME" undersigned, offer to provide consulting for "INSERT REFERENCE NUMBER" to Karandaaz Pakistan in accordance with the Price Schedule attached herewith and made part of this proposal. "THE FIRM NAME" undertake, if our proposal is accepted, to commence and complete delivery of all services specified in the contract within the time frame stipulated.

"THE FIRM NAME" agree to abide by this proposal for a period of 90 days from date fixed for opening of proposal in the invitation for proposal, and it shall remain binding upon us and may be accepted at any time before the expiration of that period.

We understand that you are not bound to accept any or all proposals you may receive. We also accept all terms of conditions RFP. We undertake that we will initiate the delivery of /Services as per the client's request, if our proposal is accepted.

The contractor hereby confirms that it has not been involved and has no association in any manner what so ever related to any act of terrorism or terrorist organization(s)/person(s) listed in any country and also in NACTA Schedules I & IV lists for proscribed companies and individuals and UN terror list.

We understand that you are not bound to accept any proposal you receive.

Dated: this-----day of -----2026

Yours sincerely,

Signature Name and title of signatory

Name, Designation and Signature of the "firm authorized Representative"

Annexure - B

[LETTERHEAD OF THE ENTITY]

UNDERTAKING REGARDING NOT BEING BLACKLISTING

It is hereby certified that **[Name of Organizations]** has not been blacklisted by any Govt, Agency/authority **as on [Date]**. The Organization will immediately inform Karandaaz in case of any change in the status at any time hereinafter.

It is further certified that the bidder or any of its personnel, agents or, suppliers and/or their employees are not directly or indirectly engaged in or support individuals, groups or entities associated with terrorism, including but not limited to the following:

- a. HM Treasury's Office of Financial Sanction Implementation-Financial sanctions consolidated list of targets;
- b. UK Home Office- Proscribed terrorist groups or organisations;
- c. United Nations- United Nations Security Council Sanctions List;
- d. World Bank- World Bank Listing of Ineligible Firms and Individuals.
- e. European Union- Consolidated List of Sanctions;
- f. Parties on US Treasury's Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) List of Specially Designated Nationals and Blocked Persons
- g. National Counter Terrorism Authority (NACTA)- Proscribed Organizations List;
- h. National Counter Terrorism Authority (NACTA)-Proscribed Persons List
- i. French DG Trésor Freeze Register Sanctions List

Name of Signatory:

Signature of Authorized Signatory

Date: __/__/__

Company stamp:

Annexure C

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

1. Does your organization currently have any actual or potential conflict of interest with Karandaaz?

☐ Yes ☐ No

2. Does your organization have any conflict of interest as defined in Clause #33 "Avoidance of Conflict of Interest" of the RFP?

☐ Yes ☐ No

3. Has your organization disclosed any actual or perceived conflict of interest to Karandaaz?

☐ Yes ☐ No

4. Do you understand and accept that if a conflict of interest is identified, your organization may be disqualified from the procurement process:

☐ Yes ☐ No

**Conflict of interest is defined in Clause 33 "Avoidance of Conflict of Interest" of the RFP.*

Name _____

Designation _____

Signature& Stamp _____

Date _____

Annexure D

Related Party Disclosure

1. Is your firm/organization a Related Party of Karandaaz:

☐ Yes ☐ No

2. Does your firm/organization have a partner who is also a Karandaaz Pakistan director, manager, or his / her relative¹:

☐ Yes ☐ No

3. If your firm/organization is a private company, does it have a member or director who is also a director or manager of Karandaaz Pakistan:

☐ Yes ☐ No

4. If your firm / organization is a public company, is a director or manager of Karandaaz Pakistan also a director of your firm / organization, or does a Karandaaz Pakistan director or manager or his / her relatives hold any shares of your firm / organizations paid-up capital:

☐ Yes ☐ No

5. Is the chief executive or manager of your firm / organization accustomed to act in accordance with the advice, directions or instructions of a director or manager of Karandaaz Pakistan (other than advice, directions, or instructions given in a professional capacity):

☐ Yes ☐ No

6. Is a director or manager of Karandaaz Pakistan accustomed to act in accordance with the advice, directions or instructions of your firm / organization or a director or manager thereof (other than advice, directions, or instructions given in a professional capacity):

☐ Yes ☐ No

¹ Here relative is taken to mean: the spouse, siblings, lineal ascendants and descendants of a person.

7. Is your firm / organization a holding company, subsidiary company, or associated company of Karandaaz Pakistan, or a subsidiary of a holding company of Karandaaz Pakistan:

☐ Yes ☐ No

Name _____

Designation _____

Signature & Stamp _____

Date _____

Note: If you have answered yes to any of the questions # 1 – 7, please provide the following minimum information (Karandaaz Pakistan reserves the right to request additional information at its discretion).

Name(s) of the interested or concerned person(s) or director(s)	
Nature of relationship, interest or concern along with complete information of financial or other interest or concern of directors, managers or key managerial personnel in the related party	
Any other relevant and material information that is necessary for the approval body of Karandaaz Pakistan to make a well -informed decision	